

Reading

Reading

A World of Continents and Cultures

Before you read

- Look at the title. Which continents and countries do you already know something about?
- Have you ever met someone from a different continent?

The world is divided into seven continents: Asia, Africa, North America, South America, Antarctica, Europe and Australia. Each continent is home to many countries, and each country has its own nationality, language and traditions. Turkey, for example, is located on two continents, Europe and Asia, which makes its culture a fascinating mix of East and West.

People from different countries often have very different daily habits. In some cultures, families eat their main meal together in the evening, while in others, lunch is the most important meal of the day. Greetings can also vary a lot: in some countries people shake hands, in others they bow, and in others they kiss on both cheeks. Learning about these customs helps travellers show respect when they visit a new place.

Nationality is not only about a passport; it is also about shared history, food and celebrations. Many young people today have friends from several different nationalities because of the internet and international schools. This is a wonderful opportunity to learn about other cultures without leaving home. By asking questions and listening carefully, students can discover how people in other parts of the world live, eat and celebrate special occasions.

Understanding other cultures also helps us understand our own culture better. When we compare our traditions with those of other countries, we notice what makes our own nationality and way of life special. This is why many schools now encourage students to learn about world cultures alongside their own history and language.

1. How many continents does the text mention?
 - a. Five
 - b. Six
 - c. Seven
 - d. Eight
2. According to the text, Turkey is located only in Asia. — *True / False*
3. What does the text say about greetings around the world?
 - a. They are always the same everywhere.
 - b. They can be very different, such as handshakes, bows or kisses.
 - c. Nobody greets each other in some cultures.
 - d. Greetings are not important.
4. According to the text, nationality is not only about a passport; it is also about shared _____, food and celebrations.

5. Why does the text say comparing traditions is useful?

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- a. It makes travelling cheaper.
 - b. It helps us understand our own culture better.
 - c. It stops people from learning languages.
 - d. It is required at international schools.

After you read

- What is one custom from another country that you find interesting?
- Do you think it is important to learn about other cultures? Why?

Food Around the World

Before you read

- What is your favourite traditional dish? Where does it come from?
- Do you think food tells us something about a country's culture?

Food is one of the best ways to learn about a country's culture. In Italy, families often gather for long meals that include pasta, fresh bread and vegetables grown nearby. In Japan, rice, fish and vegetables are the base of most meals, and food is usually presented in small, beautifully arranged portions. In Mexico, corn, beans and chilli peppers appear in almost every traditional dish, giving Mexican cuisine its famous spicy flavour.

In Turkey, meals often start with a variety of small dishes called mezes, followed by grilled meat or fish and ending with sweet desserts like baklava. Bread is a staple food and is served with almost every meal. Many Turkish families still follow the tradition of eating together and sharing food from the same plates, which shows the importance of community and hospitality in Turkish culture.

Shopping for food is also different from country to country. In some places, people buy fresh ingredients every day from local markets, while in others, they prefer to buy packaged food from large supermarkets once a week. Some people follow special diets for health or personal reasons, such as being vegetarian or avoiding certain ingredients, and shops around the world are increasingly offering more choices to meet these needs.

Trying new food is a simple but powerful way to connect with another culture. Even if you cannot travel to a country, tasting its traditional dishes can teach you about its history, geography and values. This is one reason why food culture is such a popular topic when people talk about life in different parts of the world.

1. According to the text, what gives Mexican cuisine its spicy flavour?

- a. Rice and fish
- b. Corn, beans and chilli peppers
- c. Pasta and bread
- d. Mezes and baklava

2. In Turkey, meals often start with small dishes called _____.

3. The text says that all people around the world shop for food in exactly the same way. — True / False

4. What does sharing food from the same plates show about Turkish culture, according to the text?

- a. That food is expensive
- b. The importance of community and hospitality
- c. That people don't like cooking
- d. That meals are always short

5. What is the main idea of the last paragraph?

- a. Travelling is the only way to learn about a culture.
- b. Trying traditional food helps you connect with another culture even without travelling.
- c. Food culture is not an interesting topic.
- d. Every country eats the same dishes.

After you read

- Would you like to try a traditional dish from a country you've never visited? Which one?
- How is shopping for food in your family similar to or different from the text?